BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. **GREEN PEN** Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

LESSON 160 · Lesson 160 · Investigatory Powers: RIPA 2000, Modern Safeguards and Ethics

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Time: _____ Teacher: _____

Work through the pages in order. Answer in BLACK PEN first. Check in GREEN PEN only after the Exit Ticket.

Do Now · Recall previous learning

Q1. Does giving attribution automatically permit copying protected software or images?

Q2. Why does the TLS padlock not guarantee a site is honest?

Q3. What is the purpose of an operating system's memory management?

Q4. What is referential integrity?

BLACK PEN Answer all questions first.

GREEN PEN Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

I Do · Read new knowledge

Key vocabulary

RIPA 2000 — Regulation of Investigatory Powers Act 2000, historically specified by OCR.

IPA 2016 — Investigatory Powers Act 2016, governing major modern powers.

necessity — Intrusive step is needed for a legitimate legal aim.

proportionality — Intrusion is proportionate to the objective and circumstances.

New learning

OCR historic reference — RIPA 2000 sets out specified investigatory powers and safeguards; provisions have changed over time.

Current landscape — Investigatory Powers Act 2016 and later changes govern major communications powers and oversight.

Weigh safeguards — Intrusion should be assessed against lawful authority, necessity, proportionality and oversight. A different OCR requirement, 1.5.2 , considers broader ethical choices: a legally permitted technology can still introduce censorship, biased decisions, intrusive monitoring or avoidable environmental harm.

Worked example

A public authority requests covert interception of communications to investigate a serious threat. Is 'for public safety' alone an adequate legal justification?

1. Identify proposed interception — Identify the relevant facts, purpose and authority.

2. Check lawful powers — Discuss which law or safeguard fits the situation.

3. Authorisation + oversight — No. Relevant statutory powers, lawful authorisation, necessity, proportionality and appropriate safeguards/oversight must be considered. Exact procedures depend on activity and legal power. OCR names RIPA 2000, while IPA 2016 now covers major investigatory communications powers.

4. Recognise possible harms — Some posts may be abusive, threatening or expose private information; targeted moderation can support safeguarding. Copyright-infringing uploads raise a different question from merely unpopular opinions.

5. Explain censorship risk — Over-broad filtering can silence lawful critique and reduce access to information. Offensive content is not automatically a computer-misuse offence; judge conduct, context and applicable rules separately.

BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. GREEN PEN Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

6. Model a proportionate decision — Publish clear rules, distinguish criticism from harassment, review disputed removals and offer an appeal route. Explain which safeguards are legal obligations and which are additional ethical choices .

We Do · Practise with guidance

A school wants to monitor activity on managed computers to investigate misuse. Is this identical to state interception under RIPA?

Managed school devices

Identify the relevant facts, purpose and authority.

Privacy and safeguarding

Discuss which law or safeguard fits the situation.

Apply proportionate policy

No. School monitoring has its own employment, safeguarding, privacy and policy considerations and must be lawful, transparent and proportionate as appropriate. Do not claim all ordinary IT logging requires a state-interception warrant.

A trust deploys AI to automate routine administration. It saves staff time but changes job roles, increases electricity use and may make unfair decisions from incomplete data. Evaluate.

Think: workforce, automation, fairness, energy, equipment lifetimes and personal information.

Identify opportunities

Which tasks might be reduced? What could staff do better with the time saved?

Do not treat all benefits as free

Automation can alter jobs and require retraining. Incomplete records can produce inaccurate flags. More computing may consume electricity and create hardware/e-waste impacts.

Propose a responsible deployment

Use AI for supported routine work, keep human review for consequential decisions, assess data quality, retrain affected staff and consider energy efficiency and device lifetime. Explain trade-offs, not simply “AI good” or “AI bad”.

BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. GREEN PEN Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

You Do · Work independently

BLACK PEN: Write your own answers. Do not look at the Review & Improve pages yet.

Question 1

State why RIPA 2000 appears in OCR H446 1.5.1 and name one modern related Act. [6]

Question 2

Explain necessity and proportionality in the context of a proposed surveillance measure. [6]

Question 3

A public authority wishes to inspect communications data during a serious investigation. Assess four issues it must consider before taking action. [8]

Exit Ticket · Answer before checking

Any school or authority may secretly intercept communications whenever it believes doing so is useful.

BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. GREEN PEN Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

Review & Improve · GREEN PEN

Now change to GREEN PEN. Find each original question. Tick correct answers; read the model and rewrite mistakes.

Page 1 onwards · Do Now

Q1. No. A licence or applicable exception is required.

Q2. Encryption in transit does not establish trustworthiness of operator.

Q3. Allocating and protecting memory for running programs.

Q4. Foreign keys refer to valid parent keys, subject to allowed NULL/policies.

You Do pages · Independent questions

Q1. RIPA named specification legislation [2], investigatory powers/interception context [2], Investigatory Powers Act 2016 [2].

Q2. Necessary for lawful legitimate aim [3]; scope/impact not excessive for purpose [3].

Q3. Specific legal power/authorisation [2], necessity [2], proportionality [2], safeguards/oversight and privacy rights [2].

Exit Ticket · Model answer

False. Lawful powers, necessity, proportionality and oversight matter.

Try the question again

Choose one question you got wrong. All correct? Choose the hardest.

1. Copy the whole original question:

2. Write a complete new answer in GREEN PEN. Show working if needed: